ENTERTAINER GUIDE TO PERSONAL GROWTH

Balance your carefree spirit to get the most out of life's many pleasures

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Personal Growth Matters to Entertainers

For Entertainers, life is something to experience, enjoy, and share. Like other members of the Explorer group, people with this personality type seize the moment and create a sense of fun and adventure. Spontaneous and action-oriented, Entertainers know how to have a good time. People with this personality type don't keep all the merriment to themselves, though – instead, they use their infectious enthusiasm and energy to draw others into the fun.

Gregarious and passionate, Entertainers have a definite flair. They thrive on novelty, aesthetic beauty, and physical pleasures. However, their pursuit of enjoyment can consume them, leading them to neglect such important practical matters as car maintenance and credit card payments. They can let things slide in an unbalanced manner, relying on luck or hoping that their friends will bail them out when problems arise. Entertainers are the type that might hide unopened bills in the microwave or ignore the "check engine" light on their car. Ironically, this potential failure to take responsibility can rob Entertainers of the freedom they so crave.

Entertainers who approach the responsibilities of daily living in a balanced manner know that to indulge in their carefree spirit – which is one of their most charming traits – they must strive to establish just enough structure to stay on top of practical necessities and maintain personal and financial well-being. This opens the door for them to satisfy their lust for life and their high-flying style, sharing the beauties

and pleasures of the world with the people around them. Learning this balanced approach is the essence of personal growth.

For Entertainers with a goal, this may mean learning how to step back and see all the little details that they sometimes miss. It may mean learning how to value their own opinion over that of others or how to notice when they may be making life more complicated than it needs to be. But personal growth also means recognizing and embracing the strengths that define this Extraverted personality type: their ability to connect with people and "read" those around them, the way they can focus their efforts to pull through hard times, and the seemingly endless energy they have when pursuing the projects that they most care about.

In these pages, we'll explore the three motivational aspects that drive personal growth for Entertainers: self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence. When Entertainers enjoy balance across these three aspects, they are able to fully lean into and develop their inherent strengths. Our goal is not to lay out a strict plan for Entertainers to achieve conscious personal growth, but rather to offer ideas, encouragement, and gentle guidance for the possible bumps in the road that Entertainers may encounter along life's way.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Motivation and Development

By its very nature, personal growth isn't the one-size-fits-all affair that some self-help books would have readers believe. For Entertainers, personal growth is always about balancing spontaneity with responsibility, independence with intimacy, and novelty with status quo. The goal isn't to change their intrinsic traits, but rather to help them gain a greater array of tools for getting through their lives more skillfully.

For Entertainers to grow, they must first develop self-awareness by assessing their current behaviors. It takes careful consideration, but they should try to determine whether their actions have positive long-term effects or just feel good in the moment. Replacing unhealthy behaviors with new ones that can reveal new, more fulfilling possibilities and bring Entertainers closer to what they want in life.

However, not all growth is the product of deliberate effort. Sometimes it emerges gently from the subtle shifts caused by age and maturity, and occasionally life harshly demands immediate growth in the face of hard times and crises. No matter the method, as the saying goes, "You're either getting better, or you're getting worse. There is no staying the same."

Motivational Aspects

Entertainers tend to find motivation from three closely related, but distinct, motivational aspects.

- **Self-esteem** speaks to how much Entertainers like themselves. Accepting both their flaws and strengths creates a base of internal appreciation that enables change motivated by desire instead of shame.
- **Self-respect** speaks to their sense of worth. People with this personality type value empathy and harmony, and when they live their beliefs and values, a balanced sense of pride in who they are follows.
- **Self-confidence** is the energy source that moves Entertainers forward in life. When belief in their abilities is confirmed using their skills, Entertainers are driven to make steady progress.

If these three core aspects are properly balanced, they can promote a successful, fulfilling lifestyle. If these elements become unbalanced, however, they become a source of overwhelming difficulty. For example, when Entertainers feel a lack of self-confidence, they might try to offset such feelings with behaviors that give them assurance. Such overcompensation can throw their entire lives out of balance.

In this section, we'll first examine Entertainers' characteristics in their ideal, balanced, and developed form. Using these motivational aspects in a harmonious way helps these types lead fulfilling, productive, and happy lives.

Next, we'll describe the tendencies that emerge if these aspects become unbalanced. These propensities represent departures from healthy, productive motivational strategies and explain adverse effects Entertainers experience when disconnected from their true selves.

Finally, we'll discuss what can be done to improve balance in each of the motivational aspects. Exercises, tips, and concrete actions are provided to aid the process of personal growth and development.

Self-Esteem

For Entertainers, their self-esteem is a sense of competency at whatever they choose to pursue. Since they're Extraverts with the Feeling trait, much of that competency has to do with other people.

Balanced Self-Esteem

For these types, balanced self-esteem is enhanced by – but not dependent on – knowing they have the freedom to experience life as they please and having the adequate competence to bring others into the fold with them. In endeavors that matter to them, Entertainers aim to hone their skills, be innovative, and, above all, find joy.

As their name suggests, Entertainers love to put on a good show and tend to self-improve to the point of personal satisfaction. However, it's important to remember that although these types may work hard,

they aren't perfectionists. If anything, they may consider the flaws in their work to be important defining factors and, in true Entertainer fashion, the very things that set them apart from the rest.

Unbalanced Self-Esteem

When their self-esteem drops, Entertainers are likely to hope that acquiring others' approval can restore their self-worth. At times, they may concentrate almost exclusively on how to win other people over and seek their acceptance. This intense, narrow focus may result in collateral damage, however, resulting in Entertainers' sacrificing important aspects of their lives and finding they must choose between caring for their own needs and catering to others' desires. Alas, the love of others is a fleeting thing and never measures up to self-approval.

When their self-worth takes a dive, Entertainers may begin a fruitless search for answers in other people – and in an odd twist, the less they know a person, the more they may want to please them. That's why, when their self-esteem is unbalanced, Entertainers may stop listening to the praise of friends and family, and instead turn their ears toward the criticism of acquaintances and the public, giving their opinions and values far more credit than they should.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

When their quest for love and acceptance becomes an obsession, Entertainers must step back and see the big picture – specifically, how they're fulfilling their personal needs. To do so, they can grab a piece of paper and try to clarify their personal values, or what makes them happy. They should try to imagine themselves existing in a vacuum, with no other soul around, and consider these questions:

- When were they happiest?
- What times were they proud of themselves?
- When did they feel most true to themselves?

Entertainers can extrapolate their values from their answers. For example, if they answered, "I was the happiest when I was with my family telling a story," then perhaps "family" would be one of their values. The further Entertainers break down their personal values, the easier it is to determine if they're living their lives in ways that reflect those beliefs. Are they shortchanging their health and happiness for the approval of others?

As they change their lives, Entertainers can take heart by reminding themselves that self-esteem built on a single area of accomplishment isn't sustainable. By focusing on their personal values – and on those who love them – Entertainers can accept themselves, and stop fretting over the acceptance of others.

Self-Respect

For Entertainers, self-respect comes from their ability to think on their feet and solve problems on an almost improvisational level. Their self-respect doesn't involve deep deliberation. They prefer the action encompassed in assessing a situation and providing a hands-on solution. It doesn't matter which discipline they master – the dynamic is the same. They like to think of themselves as able to manipulate the different parts of their specialty to provide results.

Balanced Self-Respect

Entertainers like themselves when they see they're flexible and able to deal skillfully with unexpected things that come at them. "Steady as she goes" brings no sense of fulfillment to these types. They assess themselves by how well they solve problems. In striving for self-respect, Entertainers exercise and hone their skill at handling sudden predicaments.

Although many personality types like some measure of stability, Entertainers find no satisfaction in staying on metaphorical "solid ground." They feel better about themselves after they've navigated choppy waters and figured out how to keep the boat upright. Successfully negotiating twisting trails beats driving down the straight

and narrow highway every time. There's no sense of accomplishment for them in sitting around being content.

Because of this, there's nothing like having Entertainers around during a crisis, and these individuals never feel better about themselves than when they're effectively dealing with one. If there's an emergency, find an Entertainer. They'll take care of the situation – and be happy in the process. They must constantly prove they have the skill and flexibility to take care of such matters in order to respect themselves.

Unbalanced Self-Respect

The problem Entertainers face is that everybody else in the world isn't an Entertainer. To feel more self-respect, some Entertainers may resort to seeking out difficulties to conquer or take risks just to prove themselves to themselves. While they continue to look for problems to solve and things to master, family, friends, and coworkers may not be so interested in constantly facing down difficulties to show their skills (or see how fun Entertainers can be). Most other people like to avoid problems and aren't as stimulated by overcoming difficulties as Entertainers are.

Others may come to see Entertainers as careless, unstable, undependable, or even, at times, dangerous. In a social or work setting, this can cause a lot of disharmony. To make these conflicts even worse, Entertainers who find themselves "on a mission" may not care very much about the opinions of others.

Think of Don Draper on the TV series *Mad Men*, and the unpopular, bold risks he frequently took to solve problems at his ad agency. This disregard for friends, business associates, and loved ones can be damaging. When their motivational engine is out of balance, Entertainers might get a shot of self-worth as they solve problems – only to learn that others aren't so enamored with them. Entertainers should try to understand boosting self-respect at the expense of others may make their lives less than satisfying when all is said and done.

Rebalancing Self-Respect

Reframing is a psychological trick we play on ourselves to create a new attitude or encourage new behavior. When we reframe, we shift our perspective. This helps us respond to things differently.

Entertainers who are likely to run over other people while overzealously trying to solve problems, create solutions, or master skills, might do well to reframe the way they look at their social or business networks as puzzles they need to solve. Each unhappy person in their social constellation is a challenge. If spouses or friends are upset, then what can Entertainers do to make them feel better? If their bosses are unhappy with Entertainers' narrow focus on a procedural headache, what can be done to solve the "boss problem?"

These are all worthy challenges for those who think about them that way. Therapists or counselors might help sometimes, but Entertainers are most likely inclined to develop these people skills in their own way.

Self-Confidence

While it might sound circular, Entertainers gain confidence when they act in confident ways. By taking bold actions, they send a message to themselves that they're on the right track and can move forward even more confidently. That such actions are bold is often the only sign of success they need. Trying new and different things drives Entertainers' self-confidence.

Balanced Self-Confidence

Many credit German writer and statesman Goethe with saying, "Boldness has genius, power, and magic in it. Begin it now." This quotation is music to Entertainers' ears. A sense of brashness gives Entertainers the thrust they need to move forward in life. They have little regard for traditional standards or rules. These are too confining and limit Entertainers' creative imagination. Boldly finding new places to be (metaphorically or literally) and new ways to do things pull Entertainers confidently into the future. The "next new thing" energizes them. They love change where others dread it. Their

attraction to daring innovation and problem-solving gives them energy and confidence.

Unbalanced Self-Confidence

Our culture admires boldness. Our heroes are those who are daring and act in larger-than-life ways. However, when the need to feel confident becomes so strong that Entertainers act boldly simply for the sake of being bold, it can be damaging. Such action can disconnect them from their social or career network by putting anything that's meaningful at risk – like business plans, security, and the things that make others feel safe. They move forward with great bluster, but those around them might just shake their heads at what they only see as erratic behavior.

Rebalancing Self-Confidence

Mission statements that describe the vision of an organization or a person have become a staple for goal-setting and self-improvement. Entertainers would do well to spend a little time expanding their comfort zone and creating a mission statement. Or, they may want to review the mission statement of any organization to which they belong. They may consider putting their own bold spin on it, but such a statement can help them stay in touch with what's relevant and important. A map like that could help Entertainers stay on the road to meaningful outcomes, even when their need to express their boldness is urging them to veer off in a different direction. This counterbalance to their Prospecting nature may help them stay in touch with the bigger picture – and the needs and goals of others.

Areas for Personal Growth

Entertainers embody a curious paradox. Gregarious and charismatic, they draw people to them. At a party, others tend to flock around them, trying to edge in on their conversations – which, more likely than not, are fascinating. Romantic partners may fall head over heels for Entertainers, attracted to their adventuresome, passionate spirits.

These influences can come with some pitfalls, however. Although Entertainers tend to be the life of the party, they're also sensitive to others and prone to bursts of moodiness.

Another area where Entertainers may struggle is planning and consistency. Spontaneous to the point of thrill seeking, Entertainers like to live in the moment and leave their options open. This mindset can create problems, however, preventing them from reaching their full potential in their careers, their relationships, and their daily lives.

Let's explore these areas further, considering how Entertainers can make use of their strengths while counterbalancing their weaknesses.

Interpersonal Effectiveness

Balanced Interpersonal Effectiveness

Entertainers are known for their cleverness, ingenuity, and artistic skills. The term "artist" can mean many things when talking about these types – some are artists in the truest sense of the word. But often, they'll use their creative skills to experience everything to the fullest and entertain other people. There is no other personality type as adept at this, and it's a trait that contributes greatly to their popularity – especially once they get enough freedom to follow their own paths.

Because of this trait, Entertainers tend to have a sensation-seeking personality and are fascinated by things they can experience with their five senses. Abstract, theoretical matters don't interest them as much – people with the Entertainer personality type seek sensual rather than mental stimulation.

Unbalanced Interpersonal Effectiveness

Entertainers are powerful when it comes to emotions. Great power comes with great responsibility – and, to add another cliché, power often corrupts. Entertainers may become so used to getting what they want through subtle manipulation that the line of what's acceptable can blur quickly.

Deeply utilitarian at heart, Entertainers are unlikely to worry too much about this; but, if they're not careful, people with this personality type could become exploitative or hurtful and find themselves in danger of drifting toward entirely selfish or even antisocial activities. Entertainers have the potential of becoming outstanding entrepreneurs or brilliant con artists, and everything in between – it's up to them to decide where to draw the line.

Also, the Entertainer personality type is one of the most impulsive and hot-blooded, cherishing novelty and unpredictability. They may engineer dramas or convince other people to do something simply for the sake of shaking things up – Entertainers cannot stand boredom and routine.

It's important to keep this trait in check, though, or these types may begin a downward spiral, where they keep taking ever greater risks and seeking ever stronger sensations, all in the name of thrills and variety. This can be especially destructive in romantic relationships – their lovers may either get stressed out by their increasing instability or join in, encouraging such adrenaline-seeking behavior.

It doesn't help that Entertainers often avoid committing to anything, knowing full well that life is unpredictable and choosing to live in the present instead of planning for the future. Many Entertainers are happy with this approach – after all, "Seize the day!" is their motto. However, other people in their lives may expect Entertainers to commit to relationships relatively early, and they may feel hurt if this expectation isn't met.

Rebalancing Interpersonal Effectiveness

People with this personality type need not worry too much about attracting significant others – probably their partners will find them instead. Entertainers may need to work on recognizing (and, if necessary, managing) their partners' expectations, though, if they want to have strong, lasting relationships.

The same principles apply to nonromantic relationships as well. Entertainers are unlikely to have any difficulties making friends and

should leverage that strength wherever possible, but their intrinsic unwillingness to settle down and stop wandering may surprise other people.

Entertainers can rebalance their spontaneity when it comes to their personal relationships by finding close, dependable friends they can use as sounding boards for decision making. These by no means have to be restrictive relationships, but rather friendships based on honesty and mutual benefit. Entertainers can add spice to their dependable friends' lives in exchange for hearing the occasional "Hey, maybe that isn't a good idea."

Quick Thinking

Balanced Quick Thinking

The most impressive trait of all Entertainers is their ability to "think on their feet" – people with this personality type are able to make snap decisions, always able to escape even the most challenging situations. This makes them excellent troubleshooters and improvisers, especially where there is a need to act quickly and ignore the established procedures, if necessary. Although Entertainers are fiercely utilitarian, willing to do what it takes to get the job done, even if it means breaking the existing traditions, they also have an exceptionally kind attitude toward other people.

Unbalanced Quick Thinking

Entertainers should be aware of their tendency to focus on the main goal and leave all other tasks aside. This attitude allows them to move quickly but poses a danger to their legacy once the main task is finished. Other people, especially those opposed to Entertainers' "Let's get this done!" attitude, may ignore the main achievement in favor of pointing fingers at all the little things left unfinished or the established procedures that have been overlooked.

Unfortunately, this amazing trait is often misunderstood and drowned out by other people's suggestions to be methodical, to not disturb the waters, to follow the well-established paths, and so on. This is

especially apparent in highly structured environments, such as schools or public institutions. Entertainer children can be chastised for being restless and impatient, and then asked why they can't be more like the "good" pupils (likely belonging to one of the Sentinel types). Younger Entertainers may feel as if their strengths are undervalued, and may even repress their spontaneity and desire for excitement to fit in.

Rebalancing Quick Thinking

Entertainers tend to be brilliant frontline executors, but mediocre administrators or logisticians. People with this personality type are at their best when accompanied by others who can sort out the logistics behind the operation.

It often takes a crisis for other people to recognize the true value of Entertainers' skills; however, this doesn't mean Entertainers should be reluctant to capitalize on their strengths or feel ashamed of them. These types should do their best to find a niche that's right for them, and then follow their instincts instead of listening to critics and naysayers.

To paraphrase Irish playwright George Bernard Shaw, "The careful man adapts himself to the world; the reckless one persists in trying to adapt the world to himself. Therefore, all progress depends on the reckless man." Entertainers should know their limitations but shouldn't be afraid to capitalize on their strengths – no other personality type knows how to enjoy the present moment as much as they do, and no one should underestimate the importance of the joy and excitement Entertainers bring to other people's lives.

Emotionality

Balanced Emotionality

Another major strength that all Entertainers share is excellent social skills. These types instinctively know what makes other people tick and what arguments they're likely to listen to. Very few personality types could be kinder than Entertainers – people with this type are masters of their observational and improvisational skills, instinctively knowing

how they should react to what others say or do. This usually leads to Entertainers being popular in many circles, both professionally and personally.

Also, Entertainers are bold and able to both notice and act on opportunities where other types can't or don't want to. This boldness and thirst for adrenaline are also likely to be very attractive to other people, including potential romantic partners. Just like many other things in their lives, Entertainers' relationships are full of both excitement and unpredictability. They're always finding something interesting to do and keeping the flame of their love affairs burning brightly.

Unbalanced Emotionality

This emotionality unavoidably has a dark side, giving Entertainers the ability to exploit other people's weaknesses, manipulating or convincing them to do something that goes against their best interests. Ultimately, it's up to these individuals to learn to channel their energy in positive directions, creating and delivering value instead of acting like con artists.

Rebalancing Emotionality

People with this personality type should be aware of this danger and keep an eye out for potential attempts at manipulation. As already mentioned, Entertainers tend to be very kind and friendly, but their good nature may be abused by less scrupulous individuals. Awareness of this tendency is perhaps the strongest way of handling both the benefits and downsides of emotionality.

Final Words

Extraverted and blessed with strong emotional intelligence, Entertainers often have an outward focus that serves them well in a social sense. They are perceptive, warm, and generous with the people around them. When they shine their spotlight on someone else, that someone is sure to feel loved and special.

But it can be hard for Entertainers to turn that spotlight from the *people* who matter to the *things* that matter. While they know how to have a good time, they may struggle to attend to all the little details that make possible the carefree life that they so deeply value. They are usually quick to ask a friend what's bothering them but may hesitate to address their own issues.

As Aristotle said millennia ago, "The hardest victory is over self." When it comes to personal growth, this "victory over self" can sometimes be as simple as making a single adjustment to our way of doing things that has an immediate (and gratifying) impact on life. But sometimes the process is a bit more complicated and requires focused effort and continual mindfulness.

It's important to remember that personal growth is not about sacrificing who you are, but rather about learning to recognize the unhelpful tendencies that interfere with your ability to live life to its fullest potential. With the tools and insights provided in this guide, it's our hope that Entertainers can balance their need for spontaneity and fun with the productive habits that will get them where they want to go in the long run.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you build a strong foundation for your self-development? Explore our Personal Growth Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Entertainer Guide to Careers*.
- Ready to better understand and strengthen your relationships? Our *Entertainer Guide to Relationships* may be just what you need.

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